

1886 Growing industrial militancy in Chicago as workers demonstrate for an eight-hour day. Police intervene, causing the Haymarket Riot. Industrial protests against low wages, long hours, poor conditions, and lack of union recognition soon spread throughout America.

1889 North and South Dakota become the 39th and 40th states of the Union. Montana, Washington, Idaho, and Wyoming join within a year.

1890 The massacre at Wounded Knee, South Dakota, is the last major military conflict between American Indian and US forces.

1890 Antitrust Law is passed to curb big-business power.

1890 The Irish population of New York is now twice that of Dublin. In 1892 the Ellis Island immigration reception center in New York is opened.

1896 Utah admitted as the 45th state of the Union after its Mormon inhabitants promise to relinquish polygamy.

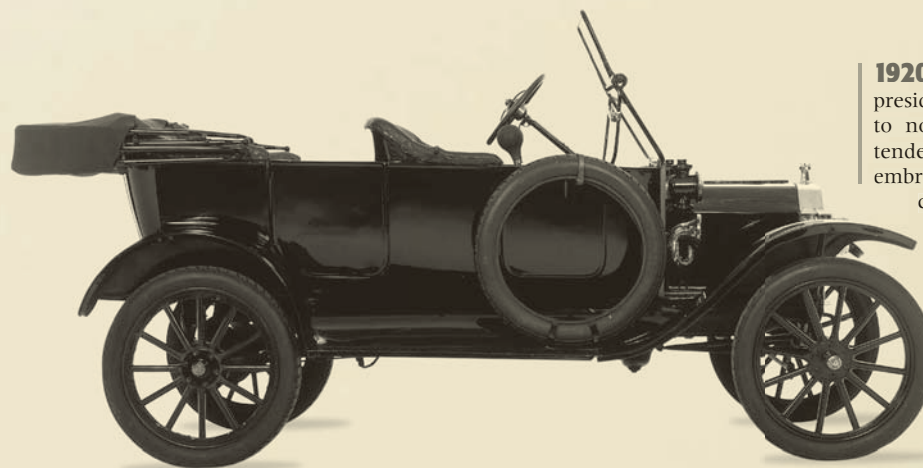
1896 The Supreme Court affirms the “separate but equal” doctrine allowing racial segregation.

1898 The Spanish-American war ends with the US gaining control of Guam, the Philippines, and Puerto Rico.



Movie capital

The attraction of more sunlight, varied settings, and lower wages turned Hollywood, a suburb of Los Angeles, California, into the center of the US film production industry after 1910. British actor Charlie Chaplin (above) was an early star.



Mass-production

The first Model T Fords were individually built in the factory at Detroit, but in 1913 they became the first cars to be mass-produced on an assembly line, a process that reduced their cost considerably.

1901 United States Steel Corporation becomes the first billion-dollar company.

1901 President William McKinley is assassinated by an anarchist in Buffalo, New York. Theodore Roosevelt becomes president.

1905 More than 1 million immigrants enter America in a year. By 1910 the US population rises to 92 million.

1908 Model T Ford production begins.

1909 The NAACP—the National Association for the Advancement of Colored People—is formed in New York to promote civil rights.

1912 New Mexico and Arizona join as the 47th and 48th states of the Union.

1912 Woodrow Wilson is elected president. Theodore Roosevelt, who had stood down in favor of William Taft in the 1908 election, stands against him, splitting the Republican vote and letting the Democrats in.

1913 The Federal Reserve Bank Act sets up a series of 12 district reserve banks overseen by a federal board. This has the power to control the supply of money and raise or lower interest rates to prevent financial collapse.

1914 US troops intervene in the Mexican civil war, landing Marines in the port city of Veracruz in April.

1914 Ludlow Massacre: a strike by Colorado coal miners turns deadly when troops fire on the strikers' camp, killing 24.

1916 Pancho Villa, Mexican rebel leader, raids Columbus, New Mexico; 18 Americans are killed. In response, the National Guard is mobilized along the US-Mexican border and a force under General John J. Pershing is sent into Mexico itself, but Villa eludes capture.

1920 Warren G. Harding is elected president on a program of “a return to normalcy,” appealing to isolationist tendencies in the country. He is soon embroiled in the “Teapot Dome”

corruption scandal over the management of naval oil reserves, but dies in office in 1923. He is succeeded by vice president Calvin Coolidge, who presides over a long period of unsustainable economic growth during the “jazz age.”

1921 William Taft, president from 1909 to 1913, is named Chief Justice of the Supreme

Court, the only man ever to head both the executive and judicial branches of the federal government.

1921 The Emergency Quota Act, and 1924's Johnson-Reed Act, both introduce quotas for immigrants based on the population of ethnic groups in the 1910 and 1890 censuses. Small quotas are allowed for Syria, Turkey, and Palestine, but all other Asian immigration to the US is now banned.

1925 The Scopes Trial takes place in Dayton, Tennessee, of a teacher charged with, and then convicted of, teaching evolution rather than creationism.

1927 The first “talkie”—*The Jazz Singer*—starring Al Jolson, opens in New York. The previous year, *Don Juan* had become the first movie with a synchronized musical score. Within a few years, the era of the silent movie is over.

1928 Herbert Hoover, a Republican, is elected 31st president by a landslide, promising that there will be “a chicken in every pot and a car in every garage.”

US WRITER (1902–68)

JOHN STEINBECK

The third American writer to win the Nobel Prize for Literature (1962), Steinbeck's novels describe the plight of ordinary Americans struggling to survive difficult times with empathy and insight. Born in California, Steinbeck hit his literary stride during the Great Depression with the short novel *Of Mice and Men* (1937) and the novel considered to be his masterpiece, *The Grapes of Wrath* (1940), which told the story of the Joads, a family fleeing the dust bowl for California.



1917 US enters World War I on the Allied side against Germany. Wilson had declared American neutrality when war broke out in 1914 and won reelection in 1916 on the slogan “He kept us out of the war.” The mood of the country became increasingly anti-German, however, after the sinking in 1915 of the SS *Lusitania* off the coast of Ireland. In February 1917 Germany announces it will attack all foreign ships in an effort to starve Britain and France of much-needed supplies. Germany also tries to divert American attention away from Europe by inciting Mexico to invade the US. When this policy is revealed by the publication of a secret telegram sent by German foreign secretary Arthur Zimmerman to his minister in Mexico, the US declares war, on April 6.

1918 The arrival of 500,000 fresh US troops in France by May 1918 and a further 313,400 in July tips the balance in the Allies' favor. As German morale collapses, an armistice is declared in November 1918. Approximately 56,000 US troops are killed and 204,000 injured in the war.

1918 The Fourteen Points for peace are proposed by President Wilson, including the setting up of the international League of Nations to prevent future wars.

1919 When Senate refuses to ratify the peace treaties drafted at Versailles and join the League of Nations, Wilson tours the country rallying support for his policies. In September he collapses and later suffers a stroke, ending any chance of the US agreeing to join the League.

1920 The 18th Amendment to the Constitution outlaws the sale of alcohol throughout the country, ushering in Prohibition. The ban has the effect of driving drinking underground into illegal speakeasies and the hands of criminal gangs, as well as supporting a massive illegal trade in bootleg liquor. Neighboring Canada and Mexico both benefit from cross-border smuggling.

1920 The 19th Amendment to the Constitution grants all women the vote.